

Post-Operative Instructions

All-on-X Dental Implants with Temporary PMMA Prosthesis

Bleeding

Some minor oozing is normal for the first 24–48 hours. Bite gently on gauze packs placed after surgery. Replace them every 30–45 minutes as needed until bleeding slows. If bleeding persists, bite gently on a moistened tea bag for 30 minutes. Avoid spitting, rinsing forcefully, or using straws, as this can dislodge the clot.

Swelling & Bruising

Swelling is common and may peak at 48–72 hours. Apply an ice pack (20 minutes on, 20 minutes off) during the first 24 hours. Keep your head elevated when resting. Bruising may appear and is normal—it should fade in a week or so.

Pain Control

Take prescribed medications as directed. Over-the-counter pain relievers (ibuprofen, acetaminophen) may be used if advised by your dentist. Do not drive or operate machinery while taking narcotic pain medication.

Diet

For the first 6–8 weeks, follow a soft diet only. This allows the implants to heal without unnecessary stress. Examples: yogurt, scrambled eggs, mashed potatoes, smoothies, pasta, well-cooked vegetables, fish. Avoid hard, crunchy, or sticky foods (nuts, chips, raw carrots, tough meats). Do not bite directly into food with your front teeth—cut food into small pieces.

Oral Hygiene

Do not brush directly on the surgical sites for the first week. After 24 hours, gently rinse with warm salt water ($\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon salt in 8 oz warm water) 3–4 times daily. Use any prescribed antimicrobial rinse (e.g., chlorhexidine) as directed. After 7–10 days, you may begin gently brushing the prosthesis with a soft toothbrush. Avoid vigorous scrubbing. Do not use water flossers or electric toothbrushes near the surgical area until cleared by your dentist.

Temporary Prosthesis Care

Your PMMA prosthesis is temporary and designed to protect the implants during healing. Do not try to remove it yourself—it has been secured by your dentist. Some speech changes and increased saliva are normal and will improve with time. Minor pressure points may occur; call us if you notice sore spots.

Activity

Rest and avoid strenuous exercise for the first 48–72 hours. Gradually return to normal activity as you feel comfortable. Avoid smoking and alcohol, as they delay healing and increase risk of implant failure.

What to Expect

You may feel tightness or pressure under the prosthesis. This is normal. Small gaps between the gums and prosthesis may appear as swelling decreases—these will be adjusted at follow-up visits. The PMMA temporary will eventually be replaced with your final permanent prosthesis after the implants have fully healed (typically 4–6 months).

Follow-Up

Attend all scheduled follow-up appointments to monitor healing and make adjustments. Call our office if you notice: Persistent or severe bleeding, increasing pain or swelling after 3–4 days, prosthesis loosening or breakage, or signs of infection (fever, pus, foul taste/odor).

Emergency Contact

If you have concerns outside of office hours, please call our emergency number: (insert office phone number).